

Bath-time fun!

If your baby has made the transition from a baby bath to a real bathtub, bath time can be a highlight of his day. Let him discover a greater sense of freedom as he splashes in the water and explores different sensations.

Keep some favorite bath toys on hand (you don't need to buy special bath toys; nonbattery plastic toys you may already have will work well). Try playing different games and activities, such as a tickle game: use a hand puppet washcloth or sponge to tickle his toes, knees, and tummy. Or sing a familiar rhyme or silly song and splash the surface water lightly as you sing. Supervise him carefully at all times while he's in or near the water.

If your baby shows signs of apprehension or dislikes this bigger environment, make it as fun and relaxing as possible—or jump in and join him in the bath.

